

MAHENDRA
VINAYAK VICHARE

37, COURIER SERVICE PROVIDER
FOUNDER, VICHARE COURIER SERVICES
INITIAL INVESTMENT IN 1996 Rs 1.5 lakh
CURRENT TURNOVER Rs 40 crore

SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE

**Success
MANTRA**

"I have always believed that this is not my best. It is yet to come."

**biggest
OBSTACLE**

Human errors, he thinks, are the greatest stumbling block in his business

**humble
BEGINNING**

He used to go from door to door, delivering parcels himself

MR POSTMAN

In 1996, when Mahendra Vinayak Vichare, 37, started Vichare Courier Services Private Limited, it seemed to be a shot in the dark. Courier services in India were the domain of unorganised players in the private sector. The only organised entity was India Post, infamous for its delays and misplaced letters. "There were operators who functioned in the domestic and international markets, but no local company was offering services within Mumbai," explains Vichare, a commerce graduate from Siddharth College in the city's suburbs.

Finding their strength in the Postal Department's weakness, Vichare Courier offered their services at lower rates. They became the first courier company to offer services within the city, and with an acknowledgement slip. With competitive rates and timely deliveries, today, the company has posted a turnover of Rs 40 crore.

Making a courier service successful, however, was no small feat. Vichare used to go from one door to the other, delivering parcels himself. He even offered to deliver unlimited letters for Rs 500 a month. His efforts paid off and the company network has grown to an impressive 18,000 regular clients. "Clients took advantage of our services. In turn, we reached out to companies and individuals, who eventually, became our regular customers," Vichare smiles in his air-conditioned cabin, one of his 87 offices in Mumbai today.

Vichare Courier has also invested its energies in training fresh recruits. It is on its way to expanding its network into cities like Pune and Nashik. Ask him about his plans for the company and he is quick to respond: "My aim is to make the Postal Department our client. Postmen should strive to become our employees. Then, I'll be a happy man."

by Swati Mathur